

PHISHING

AWARENESS TRAINING

Protecting Yourself and Your Organization
From Cyber Threats



WHAT IS PHISHING?

Phishing is a cyberattack where criminals impersonate legitimate entities to trick victims into revealing sensitive information or installing malware.

ATTACKER GOALS

Steal Credentials

Passwords & usernames

Financial Fraud

Banking & card details

Identity Theft

Personal information

⚠ Over 3.4 billion phishing emails are sent every single day.

TYPES OF PHISHING



Email Phishing

Mass emails disguised as trusted companies. Most common form.



Spear Phishing

Targeted attacks using personal info. Highly convincing.



Smishing

SMS-based phishing via text messages. Exploits mobile users.



Vishing

Voice phishing via phone calls. Impersonates banks or IRS.

RECOGNIZING PHISHING EMAILS



Suspicious or misspelled sender address (e.g., support@paypa1.com)



Urgent or threatening language — 'Act NOW or your account will be suspended!'



Spelling mistakes, poor grammar, or unusual formatting



Unexpected attachments (.zip, .exe, .doc with macros)



Requests for sensitive info like passwords or SSNs via email

IDENTIFYING FAKE WEBSITES

1

Check the URL Carefully

Look for typos: g00gle.com vs google.com

2

Verify HTTPS

Padlock icon should be present — but HTTPS alone doesn't mean it's safe

3

Watch for Misspellings

paypa1.com, arnazon.com, micros0ft.com

4

Poor Design / Broken Links

Rushed fakes often have bad formatting and dead links



PRO TIP

Hover over links before clicking to preview the destination URL.

SOCIAL ENGINEERING TACTICS



Impersonation

Pretends to be a manager, IT support, or a bank to gain trust instantly.



Creating Urgency

"Your account will be deleted in 24 hours." Forces rash decisions.



Fear & Intimidation

"You owe taxes. Pay immediately or face arrest." Panic overrides logic.



Fake Rewards

"You won a \$500 gift card!" Greed bypasses caution.

BEST PRACTICES



Use strong, unique passwords for every account



Enable Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) wherever possible



Verify requests independently — call back via official number



Keep software and antivirus updated at all times



Avoid clicking suspicious links — go directly to the website



Report suspicious emails to your IT/security team immediately

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

Fake Bank Security Alert

From: **security@your-bank-online.support** ⚠ SUSPICIOUS

Dear Customer,
Your account has been SUSPENDED due to unusual activity.
VERIFY NOW to avoid permanent closure within 24 hours.

Click here: **<http://secure-bank-verify.xyz/login>** ⚠ FAKE DOMAIN

✗ Suspicious domain ✗ Urgent/threatening language ✗ Fake external link



QUICK QUIZ

Q1 Is it safe to click links from unknown senders?

✓ NO — always verify the sender first.

Q2 What should you check FIRST in a suspicious email?

✓ The sender's email address.

Q3 Does HTTPS guarantee a website is safe?

✓ NO — HTTPS only means data is encrypted, not that the site is legitimate.



KEY TAKEAWAYS

Stay Alert

Assume any unsolicited message
could be a threat

Verify Before You Trust

Always confirm identity through
independent channels

Report Suspicious Activity

Alert your IT/security team
immediately

Questions? Contact your IT Security Team.